



LOMOLE JONATHAN:

- **SAT**- Though NU is test-optional, try as much as possible to get high SAT scores to give you an advantage over other African students who'll also be stellar applicants. Anything above 1450 would be good, but 1500+ would set you on higher grounds.
- **RECS**- I brought out that I gave back to my high school after graduating in my counselor rec through training the dance team I was in to prepare them for a competition. This played a massive role as NU values students who'll give to NU's community through knowledge or finances.

Also, ensure your recommendation letters greatly complement your brand and personality. Having one supplement means your recs would be one of the most significant places for them to know more about your personality, and what you did to push your brand.

- **Activities**- Try getting an internship that shows your maturity in some way. If possible, strive to have international activities to set you apart from other Kenyan applicants.
- **Demonstrated Interest**- Try reaching out to the AO in charge of Africa and attend the seminar they're going to have in Kenya. Vincent Mambo is better placed to advise you on this.
- **NU Students**- EdUSA has so many alumni in NU. Work with your mentors so they can connect you with these students, giving you some loopholes in NU's application process.
- **Social Pages**- NU admission's page on TikTok is quite vibrant. Try engaging with their content, for

example, commenting on their videos in a friendly way that doesn't make you seem desperate to attend NU. Also, last year they posted so much content on Taylor Swift which I indicated in my Why NU essay. This year things might change. Watch out for what will be there and try to synchronize it with your essay.

- **Personal Statement** - As much as you'll trauma dump or play the African card, make sure you show growth in your essay
- Lastly, **weka Mungu Mbele**. NU is quite competitive because many reapplicants target it. However, with hard work, sheer determination, and prayer, you'll beat them and find yourself in Evanston next fall.

VINCENT MAMBO:

- Because Northwestern has an emphasis on **interdisciplinary learning**, strive to bring this out in your application, especially in your "Why Northwestern statement". How can you bridge different fields e.g Environmental Science and

Social Policy or Agriculture and Computer Science to enable you to achieve a certain goal.

- Northwestern is big on **community involvement**. Right from your activities to the supplement and possibly even your personal statement, always show that whatever you are doing is for the benefit of a larger group of people. Even when stating a personal achievement in your activities, ensure that you show how that helped someone else. If you created a water purifying device and won first place at a certain competition, show what you did with that initiative beyond that.
- **Demonstrated interest**. Reaching out to admissions officers, especially the one in charge of admissions in our region, can be a big plus. I attended a college fair where I met and interacted with an AO from Northwestern. I made sure she knew my name and that I got her contacts after which we continued to communicate up until the time I submitted my application. Make a good impression and it will work in your favor.

- **Develop your brand** fully. Make sure it is evident throughout your application and don't be afraid to portray the challenges that you have faced. The African card is very common; ensure it appears somewhere.
- **Stereotypes.** It is important to show these in your application. Needless to say, this is something most AOs want to see in any application. While talking to the AO at the college fair I attended, she told that she wants to see these in your application to Northwestern.
- Let your **recommendations and activities**, even those in your gap year statement, show collaboration. You don't always have to be the leader but show that you work with people to achieve what you intend to achieve. Northwestern is a private research institute so depending on the major that you're applying with, show collaboration in any research you have done or intend to partake in.
- **SAT.** Even though Northwestern is test-optional, strive to score highly on your SATs, an impressive

SAT makes you stand out from the massive group of applicants. Especially in RD.

- **Prompt.** In the Why Northwestern prompt, make sure you show your interest in the school by getting specific nitty-gritty small examples in Northwestern that are related to your major.